illumio

CIO CISO XGERMANY · MUNICH 2026

The Deck of Hard Truths

An interactive cybersecurity roundtable game

WHAT IS THIS?

A deck of **26 cards** built to spark real conversations between security leaders. No vendor pitches. No textbook answers.

Draw a card. React. The table reacts back. Repeat.

THE THREE CARD TYPES

🔴 **BREACH SCENARIO** 8 CARDS

"This just happened. What do you do?"

You have **60 seconds** to describe your response. Table then votes: **contained** or **catastrophic.**

🟡 **HOT TAKE** 10 CARDS

"Defend this. 30 seconds. Even if you disagree."

Defend the statement for **30 seconds** — even if you think it's wrong. Then the table debates.

🔵 **TRADE-OFF** 8 CARDS

"Pick a side. No 'it depends.'"

Two competing priorities. Pick **one** and defend it. The table shows hands for each side.

Illumio · Manual · A5 · Trim 148×210mm · Bleed 3mm · Page 1 (front)

HOW TO PLAY

1. **Fan cards face-down**
   Color-coded backs are visible, so you know the card type before you draw.
2. **Draw a card**
   Moderator picks someone or takes a volunteer. Choose your color (risk level) — or go blind.
3. **Read it aloud**
   The moderator reads, so the drawer has a moment to think.
4. **Respond**
   🔴 60s for breach scenarios · 🟡 30s for hot takes · 🔵 pick a side immediately for trade-offs.
5. **Table reacts**
   Show of hands, quick debate, or moderator picks a dissenter to challenge. 2–3 minutes total per card.
6. **Move on**
   The energy is in snap decisions, not deep dives. That's what the main discussion is for.

GROUND RULES

✅ Do

→Be honest. "I don't know" is valid.
→Challenge each other. Disagreement is the point.
→Share real stories. Anonymize if needed.
→Have fun. Serious content, not a serious vibe.

🚫 Don't

→Give vendor pitches.
→Say "it depends" on trade-offs.
→Dominate the table.
→Take it outside. Chatham House Rule.

SUGGESTED TIMING · 60-MINUTE SESSION

0:00	Icebreaker round
0:08	Discussion block 1
0:28	Discussion block 2
0:48	Discussion block 3
0:58	Wrap-up

0:05	🃏 Draw 1 warm-up card
0:23	🃏 Draw 2 cards
0:43	🃏 Draw 2 cards
0:55	🃏 Draw 1 final card

MODERATOR Read aloud yourself. Push back on corporate answers: "OK, but what would you *actually* do at 3 AM?" After each response, quick poll: who agrees, who'd do something different.

EVERYONE Honest > polished. If your gut says "we'd be screwed" — say that. Everyone here has been there.